



Figure 2: Tabs

The `:tabclose [N]` command closes the Nth tab page. This command can fail in the same way as the `:tabclose` command. Please note that the tab page counting begins from '1'. For instance, to close the third tab page, use the syntax below:

```
:tabclose 3
```

The `:tabonly` command closes all other tab pages and shows the current tab page only. This command execution can fail if the in-memory buffer of any tab page is modified but not yet written to the disk. In addition to this, to close the current tab, we can use Vim's regular commands as well—for instance, `wq`, `q!`, `:x`, `ZZ` and so on.

Navigating tab pages

Vim provides several ways to get information about tab pages. For instance, the `:tabs` command provides a summary of all open tabs. It shows a `>` symbol for the current window and shows a `+` symbol for modified buffers. Figure 2 illustrates this.

By default, tab page labels are shown at the top of the Vim window only when tab pages are open. To display tab page labels all the time, use the following command:

```
:set showtabline=2
```

Similarly, to hide the tab page labels, use `0` instead of `2` in the above command.

We can use any of the commands below to navigate tab pages:

```
:tabn
:tabn [N]
:tabnext
:tabnext [N]
:tabN
:tabN [N]
:tabNext
:tabNext [N]
:tabp
:tabp [N]
```

```
:tabprevious
:tabprevious [N]
```

As the name suggests, the `:tabn` command jumps to the next tab page. Tab page navigation wraps around from the last to the first one. For instance, if there are five tab pages open and currently we are at the fifth tab page, then execution of the `:tabn` command causes it to go to the first tab page. Similarly, `:tabn [N]` jumps to the Nth tab page. `:tabnext` and `:tabnext [N]` work exactly like the `:tabn` and `:tabn [N]` commands, respectively.

The `:tabN` command jumps to the previous tab page. Tab page navigation wraps around from the first one to the last one. For instance, if there are five tab pages open and currently we are at the first tab page, then execution of the `:tabN` command causes it to go to the fifth tab page. Similarly, `:tabN [N]` goes N tab pages back. `:tabNext` and `:tabNext [N]` work exactly similar to the `:tabn` and `:tabn [N]` commands, respectively.

The `:tabp` and `:tabprevious` commands work exactly the same way as the `:tabN` command. The `:tabprevious [N]` and `:tabp [N]` commands work the same way as the `:tabN [N]` command.

In addition to this, we can directly jump to the first or last tab page by using the following commands.

The `:tabfirst` or `:tabrewind` command jumps to the first tab page. Similarly, the `:tablast` command jumps to the last tab page. Vim also allows tab page navigation in command and insert mode. For instance, in command mode, we can use the following commands.

```
gt : Jumps to the next tab page. Tab page navigation
wraps around from the last to the first one.
gT : Jumps to the previous tab page. Tab page
navigation wraps around from the first one to the last one.
[N]gt : Jumps to the 'N'th tab page in forward direction.
Tab page navigation wraps around from the last to the first one.
[N]gT : Jumps to the 'N'th tab page in backward
direction. Tab page navigation wraps around from the first
one to the last one.
```

In addition to the above commands, we can use the following tab page navigation commands either in command or insert mode.

```
Ctrl + PageDown : Jumps to the next tab page. Tab page
navigation wraps around from the last to the first one.
Ctrl + PageUp : Jumps to the previous tab page. Tab page
navigation wraps around from the first one to the last one.
[N]Ctrl + PageDown : Jumps to the 'N'th tab page in
forward direction. Tab page navigation wraps around from the
last to the first one.
[N]Ctrl + PageUp : Jumps to the 'N'th tab page in
backward direction. Tab page navigation wraps around from
the first one to the last one.
```

Miscellaneous commands

We have seen that we can open and navigate tab pages in any order. Wouldn't it be great if we could rearrange the order of